



On the fast lane: In the third ODI against Australia recently, Smriti Mandhana hammered the second-fastest century in women's cricket history — the quickest ever by an Indian.

SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Age of audacity

Change is the only constant. As bumper-stickery as this adage sounds, it has been the tagline for the ODI format for much of the last decade.

Lavanya Lakshmi Narayanan
lavanya.ln@thehindu.co.in

Seven hundred and eighty-one runs. This was the mammoth match aggregate India and Australia amassed in the final ODI of the recent three-match series in New Delhi. What started as an innocuous decider quickly became one of the best one-day internationals in the history of the women's game, with multiple records hacked away along the way. Those with a theatrical vein will appreciate the timing of this match. How often does one get to see the most dominant side in

the sport walking around red-faced, lost for answers? Less than a fortnight away from a World Cup to be staged in the same country, this fixture earned the potential to single-handedly become the tournament's biggest endorsement.

Come a long way

Change is the only constant. As bumper-stickery as this adage sounds, it has been the tagline for the ODI format for much of the last decade. "There has been a shift in the sense that the numbers are going up, the average scores have gone up, and the way they're going about the entire format is different now," W.V. Raman, former head coach of the